



"What is the Essence of Being a Woman?"

That was the final question. Sushmita Sen's answer, "A gift of God we must all appreciate", clinched the Miss Universe crown for her on May 21, while Aishwarya Rai followed it by winning the Miss World pageant later in the year.

20,000

Kashmiri militants were said to have been trained in 105 terrorist camps, both private and ISI-sponsored, between 1991 and 1994.

- Rwandan President Juvénal Habyarimana and Burundi President Cyprien Ntaryamira died when a missile shot down their jet near Kigali, Rwanda.



- Formula 1 driver Ayrton Senna (above) died in an accident during San Marino Grand Prix. Another racer, Roland Ratzenberger, was killed on the previous day at the same track during qualifying.
- Nelson Mandela became South Africa's first Black president. The anti-apartheid activist had spent 27 years in prison.

"THIS IS MY FINEST HOUR."

Kapil Dev

That's what Kapil Dev said in 2002 when he was crowned Wisden's Indian Cricketer of the Century. Its roots lay in 1994. More than a decade after that unforgettable World Cup day on the Lords' balcony, Kapil basked in that king-of-the-world feeling again when he took his 432nd Test wicket, against Sri Lanka in Ahmedabad on February 8 to become Test cricket's most prolific wicket-taker. Then in March, he became the first to take 250 wickets in one-day internationals. Kapil retired that year, playing his last Test in Hamilton, New Zealand, in March and his last one-day against the West Indies in Faridabad later that year.



SHADEL P. MARQUEZ/AN

<< DID YOU KNOW

On December 30, India ratified the pact that brought the World Trade Organisation into existence, ushering in an era of reforms in tariffs, subsidies and intellectual property rights.